Testing the timeline, step by step

You'll play a coordinator who receives six client estimates in a row and turns each one into a project. After each one you check that the app planned it sensibly. You can't break anything: it all runs in a practice copy of the app.

What's in this part

A–D	**Setup** (once, about 15 minutes)
1	Northwind Bakery: a small website
2	Northwind phase 2: sharing work out
3	Cedar Clinic: senior-only work
4	Lakeside Gym: someone on vacation
5	Harbor Realty: Thanksgiving
6	Pine & Co: starting on Christmas Day

Each scenario takes 5–10 minutes. Do them **in order, in one sitting**: each project keeps people busy for the next one. Part 2 (scenarios 7–12) continues in the same browser.

How every scenario page works

DO	Numbered steps. Do them top to bottom. **Purple words** are buttons or tabs to click; `grey boxes` are text to type.
CHECK	What you should see. Tick each box.
WRITE DOWN	Copy one or two dates from the screen.
OPTIONAL	An extra test. Skip it if you're short on time.

Six words you'll see

- **Day 1**: the first working day on or after the day you test. Day 2 is the next working day, and weekends and holidays are not counted. **The dates in this guide were produced with Day 1 = Wed Nov 4, 2026**, so Day 5 is Tue Nov 10 and Day 6 is Thu Nov 12 (Nov 11 is Veterans Day). Testing on another day? Count by Day number. Scenarios 5–10 can differ more, because earlier work may have cleared by then, so judge those by the "glance" rules.
- **Best-fit**: give each task to the person with the most stars, even if they're busy. If several tie, the one who finishes first gets it.
- **Fastest**: give each task to whoever can finish it soonest.
- **Work key**: what a person is allowed to do, e.g. "IT Level 2". Level 2 is senior and can also take Level 1 work; Level 1 can't take Level 2.
- **"after 17h already booked"**: that person had 17 hours of earlier work, so this task waits behind it. Hover over a person's name in **See who does what** to read this reason.
- **Launch date**: one date, shown on the **Who does the work** card, the Scope & risk summary and the Timeline chart's caption. The chart's bars can run past it, because they assume one person at a time and include DNS time.

SETUP · DO THIS ONCE

Get the practice app ready

Four short stages. When you finish D, everyone on the team is free and set up the same way the expected results assume.

A Open the practice copy

Why not the real app? In the real app, starting a project creates a real deal in Zoho and a real purchase order in billing, and billing can't delete one. The practice copy (called **Demo**) plans exactly the same way but keeps everything in your browser.

1. If the app is already running in a terminal, stop it (click the terminal, press **Ctrl + C**).
2. Open **Git Bash** in the project folder (not PowerShell) and paste:
   `NEXT_PUBLIC_SUPABASE_URL= NEXT_PUBLIC_SUPABASE_ANON_KEY= npx next dev -p 3001`
3. When it says "Ready", open `http://localhost:3001/dashboard` in Chrome.
4. Top left, next to "Timeline Estimator", the badge must say **Demo**. If it says **Live**, close the tab and ask for help.
5. Tested here before? Press **F12** → **Application** → **Storage** → **Clear site data**, then reload. Your browser may still hold the old team.
6. If a Welcome box appears, click **Later**.

B Empty the sample data

1. Bottom left, in your name card, change the role dropdown to **Admin**.
2. Click **Projects**. Delete all four sample projects: open each one's ⋯ menu → **Delete** → confirm.
3. Click **Workload** → **Team**. Everyone should show **0 h** of open work.
4. Click **Settings** → **Time off** → **Team time off**. Delete both sample entries (Martin's "Annual leave" and Arvin's "Morning only").

C Check the team

The practice copy already has this team. Click **Team** and check the work keys on each row. To see stars, click the ☆ button on a row. You don't need to change anything.

PERSON	WORK KEY	STARS THAT MATTER	HOURS A WEEK
Daniel	IT · Level 2	WordPress ★5	40
Francis Jan	IT · Level 2	WordPress ★5	40
Martin	IT · Level 2	WordPress ★5	20
Jeff	IT · Level 2	WordPress ★4	40
Arvin	IT · Level 1	WordPress ★4	40
Ronel	IT · Level 1	WordPress ★3	32
Patrick	QA Tester · Level 2	Quality Assurance ★5	40
Carl	Creative · Level 2	Figma ★5	40
Sydney	Creative · Level 1	Photoshop ★5	32

Nobody holds a Project Manager key on purpose, so planning work stays unassigned for a person to staff. In the practice copy, a work key you change lasts until you reload the page.

D Hours and holidays

1. **Workload** → **Team**: the hours match the table above, and everyone shows **0 h** of open work.
2. **Settings** → **Workspace** → **Holidays**: all eleven should say **Day off**.

Setup done. Projects list empty, Estimator list empty, everyone at 0 h, badge says Demo.

READ ONCE BEFORE SCENARIO 1

Three things you'll do in every scenario

1 · Create an estimate and add its lines

1. **Estimator** → **New estimate**. Type the title and client from the scenario page; platform stays **WordPress**. Click **Create and open**.
2. You land on **Line items**. There's one empty starter row: **use it for the first line**.
3. For each line: type the **title**, open the row's details, set **Role** and **Base hours**. Leave Tier on Basic and Qty on 1.
4. For the next line, click **Add row** and repeat.

A row without a title doesn't become a task, so don't leave the starter row empty.

2 · Look at the plan

1. Click the **Adjust** tab. For typed-in lines, untick all four boxes under **Roll-up add-ons**: **Responsive**, **Design**, **QA** and **PM**. Otherwise a Design phase comes first and building doesn't start on Day 1.
2. Find the card **Who does the work**.
3. Pick **Best-fit** or **Fastest**, as the scenario says. The card shows the **launch date**. QA waits for its planned slot, so the launch often stays put even when building finishes sooner.
4. Click **See who does what**: every task with its person and dates.

3 · Turn it into a project

1. Top right, change the status to **Approved**.
2. Click **Start project** → **Review schedule**. It should match what you saw on the Adjust tab.
3. Click **Confirm & create**. The project now exists, and its people are busy for the next scenario.

Glance at these every time

You don't need to write these down. Just stop and note it if one looks wrong.

- [ ] No task starts or ends on a **weekend** or a **holiday**.
- [ ] One person never has **two tasks at the same time**.
- [ ] **QA** (testing) comes after the building work, not before.
- [ ] **IT Level 2** work only ever goes to **Daniel, Francis Jan, Martin or Jeff**.

Something looks wrong? Write down the scenario number, the person, the task and the dates shown, and take a screenshot of **See who does what**. Then carry on with the next step.

1 Northwind Bakery: a small website

You're checking that **the most-starred people get the work and start on Day 1**.

DO

Title `S1 Northwind Bakery`

Client `Northwind Bakery`

LINE TITLE	ROLE	BASE HOURS
Homepage build	IT · Level 1	8
About & Services pages	IT · Level 1	6
Contact form	IT · Level 1	3
QA pass	QA Tester · Level 1	4

1. Create the estimate and add the four lines.
2. **Adjust** → **Roll-up add-ons**: untick all four (**Responsive**, **Design**, **QA**, **PM**).
3. Pick **Best-fit** → **See who does what**.
4. Set the status to **Approved**. The card locks and now says "Quoted launch".
5. **Start project** → **Review schedule** → **Confirm & create**.

CHECK

TASK	SHOULD GO TO	WHEN
Homepage build	Daniel	Day 1 (Nov 4)
About & Services pages	Francis Jan	Day 1 (Nov 4)
Contact form	Martin	Day 1 (Nov 4)
QA pass	Patrick	Day 4 (Nov 9)

- [ ] All IT work goes to the three ★5 people. They tie on stars, so each task goes to whoever finishes first.
- [ ] Building starts on **Day 1**, not Day 2.
- [ ] The launch date is **Day 4 (Nov 9)**.
- [ ] **Workload** → **Team**: Daniel **8 h**, Francis **6 h**, Martin **3 h**, Patrick **4 h**, everyone else 0 h.

WRITE DOWN

Launch date

Result: ○ Pass ○ Fail

2 Northwind phase 2: sharing work out

You're checking that **Fastest uses whoever is free**, while Best-fit waits for the most-starred people.

DO

Title `S2 Northwind Phase 2`

Client `Northwind Bakery`

LINE TITLE	ROLE	BASE HOURS
Blog setup	IT · Level 1	8
Menu page	IT · Level 1	6
Gallery	IT · Level 1	3
QA pass 2	QA Tester · Level 1	4

1. Create the estimate and add the four lines.
2. **Adjust** → **Roll-up add-ons**: untick all four (**Responsive**, **Design**, **QA**, **PM**).
3. **Best-fit** → **See who does what**. Compare with the table below.
4. Switch to **Fastest** and compare again.
5. Leave it on Fastest. Approve → **Start project** → **Review schedule** → **Confirm & create**.

CHECK

TASK	BEST-FIT	FASTEST
Blog setup	Daniel, Day 2 (Nov 5)	Arvin, Day 1 (Nov 4)
Menu page	Francis Jan, Day 1 → 2	Jeff, Day 1
Gallery	Francis Jan, Day 2	Ronel, Day 1
QA pass 2	Patrick, Day 4 (Nov 9)	Patrick, Day 4 (Nov 9)

- [ ] Best-fit only uses ★5 people, even though they still have scenario 1 work.
- [ ] Fastest gives the work to three free people, who all finish on Day 1.
- [ ] The launch is the same both ways (Nov 9): QA waits for its planned slot.
- [ ] **Workload** → **Team**: Daniel 8 h, Francis 6 h, Martin 3 h, Arvin 8 h, Jeff 6 h, Ronel 3 h, Patrick 8 h.

WRITE DOWN

Launch with Best-fit

Launch with Fastest

Result: ○ Pass ○ Fail

3 Cedar Clinic: senior-only work

You're checking that **Level 2 work never goes to a Level 1 person**, even one who is free.

DO

Title `S3 Cedar Clinic Portal`

Client `Cedar Clinic`

LINE TITLE	ROLE	BASE HOURS
Patient login	IT · Level 2	16
Appointment page	IT · Level 1	4
QA pass 3	QA Tester · Level 1	3

1. Create the estimate and add the three lines.
2. **Adjust** → **Roll-up add-ons**: untick all four (**Responsive**, **Design**, **QA**, **PM**).
3. **Fastest** → **See who does what**.
4. Approve → **Start project** → **Review schedule** → **Confirm & create**.

CHECK

TASK	SHOULD GO TO	WHEN
Patient login (Level 2)	Daniel	Day 2 → Day 3 (Nov 5–6)
Appointment page	Francis Jan	Day 1 → Day 2 (Nov 4–5)
QA pass 3	Patrick	Day 5 (Nov 10)

- [ ] Patient login went to a Level 2 person, never Ronel or Arvin.
- [ ] The launch date is **Day 5 (Nov 10)**.
- [ ] **Workload** → **Team**: Daniel 24 h, Francis 10 h, Patrick 11 h. Arvin, Jeff, Martin and Ronel are unchanged.

OPTIONAL **Do this between steps 3 and 4, using the sidebar and not a reload.** On **Team**, set Daniel's IT key to L1, then go back with the browser's Back button. Patient login moves to **Francis Jan** (Nov 4–6) and the Appointment page to Daniel (Nov 5). Set Daniel back to L2 before you approve.

WRITE DOWN

Who got the Level 2 task

Result: ○ Pass ○ Fail

4 Lakeside Gym: someone on vacation

You're checking that **nobody gets work on a vacation day**.

DO

1. First, book Daniel's vacation. **Settings** → **Time off** → **Team time off** → choose Daniel → **Add for Daniel**. Type: PTO / vacation. Start: **Day 4** (Mon Nov 9). End: 4 days later (Fri Nov 13). Save.

Title `S4 Lakeside Gym`

Client `Lakeside Gym`

LINE TITLE	ROLE	BASE HOURS
Homepage	IT · Level 1	12
Class schedule	IT · Level 1	10
Membership page	IT · Level 1	6
QA pass 4	QA Tester · Level 1	4

1. Create the estimate and add the four lines.
2. **Adjust** → **Roll-up add-ons**: untick all four (**Responsive**, **Design**, **QA**, **PM**).
3. **Best-fit** → **See who does what**. Write down the launch date.
4. Switch to **Fastest**. Write down the launch date again.
5. Leave it on Fastest. Approve → **Start project** → **Review schedule** → **Confirm & create**.

CHECK

TASK	BEST-FIT	FASTEST
Homepage	Francis Jan, Nov 5–6	Francis Jan, Nov 5–6
Class schedule	Francis Jan, Nov 6–9	Jeff, Nov 4–5
Membership page	Martin, Nov 4–6	Arvin, Nov 5
QA pass 4	Patrick, Nov 16	Patrick, Nov 16

- [ ] **Daniel gets none of this work**, even though he has ★5: he's busy, then away.
- [ ] The launch is Nov 16 both ways. It sits later than in scenario 3 because there are more hours to build and the team has one person fewer that week.
- [ ] **Calendar** → **Team**: Daniel's vacation shows, with no task of his on those days.
- [ ] **Workload** → **Team**: Daniel 24 h, Francis 22 h, Jeff 16 h, Arvin 14 h, Patrick 15 h.

WRITE DOWN

Launch with Best-fit

Launch with Fastest

Result: ○ Pass ○ Fail

5 Harbor Realty: Thanksgiving

You're checking that **a questionnaire estimate runs in the right order and skips Thanksgiving**.

DO

This one uses the questionnaire instead of typing lines, and its add-ons are already off.

1. New estimate: title `S5 Harbor Realty`, client `Harbor Realty`.
2. Click the **Scope & risk** tab → **Start guided scoping**.
3. Section 2 **Scope & Structure**: Total Pages `6`, Unique Templates `2`. Answer No to everything else.
4. Sections 4, 5, 6 and 8: untick **Include this section in the estimate** on each.
5. Section 7 **Timeline**: Project Start Date `2026-11-23`, review turnaround `1`.
6. Click **Generate line items**, then **Adjust** → **Best-fit** → **See who does what**.
7. Approve → **Start project** → **Review schedule** → **Confirm & create**.

CHECK

PHASE	WHO	WHEN
Discovery	**Nobody** (2 tasks to staff by hand)	Nov 23–24
Design & UX	Carl, Sydney	Fri Nov 27 – Dec 3
Development	Daniel, Francis Jan, Martin	Dec 15–18
QA & Testing	Patrick	Dec 31 – Jan 7
Launch & Handoff	Martin	Jan 13–15

- [ ] The card says "20 of 22 tasks have someone", and the launch date is **Jan 15, 2027**. The Scope & risk summary and the Timeline caption show the same date.
- [ ] **Scope & risk** → **Timeline**: the chart mentions Thanksgiving, and nothing starts or ends on **Thu Nov 26**. (Fri Nov 27 is a normal working day.)
- [ ] "Bug fixes" runs Dec 31 → Jan 4, stepping over New Year's Day.
- [ ] The new project has **5 sprints**, and no Content or SEO sprint (you switched those off).
- [ ] Building and testing start well after the phase before them finishes, because each phase's slot assumes one person working at a time.

WRITE DOWN

Launch date

Result: ○ Pass ○ Fail

6 Pine & Co: starting on Christmas Day

You're checking that **a start date on a day off moves to the next working day**.

DO

1. New estimate: title `S6 Pine & Co`, client `Pine & Co`.
2. **Scope & risk** → **Start guided scoping**. Answer it the same as scenario 5 (6 pages, 2 templates, sections 4, 5, 6, 8 off).
3. Section 7: Project Start Date `2026-12-25` (Christmas, a Friday), review turnaround `1`.
4. **Generate line items** → **Adjust** → **Fastest** → **See who does what**.
5. Open **Scope & risk** → **Timeline** and look at the first bar.
6. Try two more start dates in section 7: `2026-12-26` (Saturday), then `2026-12-28`. Then set it back to `2026-12-25`.
7. Approve → **Start project** → **Review schedule** → **Confirm & create**.

CHECK

- [ ] The first bar starts **Mon Dec 28**, not Dec 25.
- [ ] Dec 26 and Dec 28 give the **same** plan as Dec 25.
- [ ] Design starts Dec 31, and nothing starts or ends on **Fri Jan 1** (New Year's Day).
- [ ] Building is shared by more people than in scenario 5 (Daniel, Jeff, Francis Jan, Arvin, Ronel), because this is Fastest.
- [ ] The card says "20 of 22 tasks have someone", and the launch date is **Feb 17, 2027**.
- [ ] In Review schedule, no task is dated Dec 25, 26, 27 or Jan 1.

WRITE DOWN

First bar starts	Launch date

Result: ○ Pass ○ Fail

Part 1 done. You should have six projects. Carry on with **Part 2** in the same browser. Don't clear anything in between: scenarios 7–12 build on this work.